

Developer Relations Portfolio — Chris Kenst

Bio

I'm a long-time software tester, automation engineer, technology director, and community leader with over 20 years of experience (yikes!). I specialize in helping engineering teams improve testing practices by focusing on risk and improving feedback loops. I enjoy teaching and coaching testers, simplifying complex technical topics, facilitating conversations, and writing. Currently I'm in a part-time (40 hours per month) Developer Relations role with Mailinator while pursuing a full-time opportunity - ideally in developer advocacy,

Why AppliTools

I admire AppliTools for its longstanding innovation in test automation and its positive impact on the testing community. I'm eager to contribute to that mission while expanding on my budding Developer Relations career. I believe my background in testing, education, and community leadership enable me to make a meaningful and positive impact at AppliTools. I have a history of collaborating with AppliTools through community initiatives and at one point, my articles on installing Selenium on macOS were referenced in AppliTools documentation.

SECTION 1: Technical Writing Samples

1. [Installing Ghost Locally on macOS with Hot Reload of Templates](#) - A practical step-by-step tutorial teaching local development setup, CLI usage, and templating workflows. Demonstrates the ability to write clear developer-facing tutorials.
2. [Foundation Models and Beyond](#) - An article that breaks down complex AI concepts into understandable terms. Shows skill in technical explanation and simplifying emerging technical topics for a broad audience.
3. [Unit Testing Your E2E Test Framework](#) - Explains how and why you should unit test end-to-end test frameworks. Highly relevant to modern test automation and AppliTools users. Strong example of clear, practical technical writing.

SECTION 2: Technical Talks (Video + Slides)

1. [Contributing to GitHub is for Everyone. Slides](#). - A conference talk demonstrating how to create a GitHub repository, clone it locally, and use Git for version control. Practical, hands-on, and targeted at developers and testers looking to contribute to open source.
2. [How Many Ways Are There to Automate a Test](#). - A technical talk about viewing test automation as software controlling testing activities. By framing automation this way, teams can better understand what parts of the process they can automate, extend, or improve.
3. My favorite presentations have been workshops and tutorials.
 - a. At [STARWest in 2019](#) I gave a hands-on tutorial called Testing Today's Web Applications.
 - b. At [CAST in 2018](#) I gave a hands-on tutorial called A Quick Introduction to Domain Testing: Beyond Quick Tests.

Note: Most of my recorded talks are from earlier in my career and several recordings have since disappeared. After transitioning into management, I focused more on facilitating webinars and running conferences rather than speaking. (I've run five in-person professional conferences and hosted numerous webinars.) Facilitation is something I enjoy just as much as teaching.

With my recent shift toward hands-on technical work and DevRel responsibilities, this is changing. I'm actively building new demo content and have plans to deliver technical talks and tutorials for Mailinator.

SECTION 3: Code Samples and Demo Repositories

1. [YouGotMailinator](#). A Node.js + Express demo application created to support Mailinator educational content and demo videos. Demonstrates my ability to build purpose-built demo apps for DevRel.
2. [Mailinator JavaScript SDK Examples](#). I was surprised at how few examples Mailinator had for any of its SDKs. Even AI coding assistants routinely generated incorrect ones. I created new examples and contributed them to the SDK repository. These will eventually be incorporated into the published docs.
3. [Mailinator's Quickstart Guide](#). After rebuilding their entire documentation system, I wrote a five minute quickstart guide using curl and Mailinator's API. (It's the first of our tutorials.) All the published developer documentation, including the onboarding flow, is

written by me. This work demonstrates strong API explanation, onboarding design, and developer-focused writing.

SECTION 4: Podcasts and Recorded Interviews

I've been on the AB Testing Podcast, the Testing Show and the TestGuild Podcast. These were all as an individual contributor. They demonstrate my comfort with live conversation, technical interviewing, and engaging with the testing community.

All podcast appearances, media appearances, publications, hosted conferences, etc. are listed on my [Publications page](#). (It's mostly so I can remember when people ask, like right now!)

SECTION 5: Community Leadership and Background

- Former President of the Association for Software Testing (AST)
- 10+ years of leadership in the testing community, including service on the AST board
- 20+ years in professional software testing, automation and leadership roles
- Extensive experience running conferences, events, and community initiatives
- Longstanding open-source community contributor and curator (testingconferences.org)
- Active presence on GitHub, X/Twitter, LinkedIn, StackOverflow, and across many testing and development Slack communities
- Past collaboration with AppliTools through community sponsorships, marketing initiatives, and historically referenced content!